



WAGE WOES

MEDICOS of Uttar Pradesh brave water cannons in Lucknow demanding a hike in their monthly internship allowance of Rs 1,950, which is equivalent to Rs 65 per day, the minimum wage fixed for labourers in the unorganised sector.



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NEARLY 88 PER CENT OF MUMBAI'S STREET FOOD TESTED IN A SURVEY WAS FOUND TO BE UNFIT FOR CONSUMPTION.

MUMBAI | Sample This

The popularity of street food in Mumbai can be judged by the number of people thronging stalls selling the staples: *vada pav*, sandwiches, *sev puri*. A survey by a diagnostic centre wants to tell patrons to rein in their cravings as it has found most street food unfit for consumption. Metropolis Healthcare Ltd conducted a random survey of street food around Mumbai and found 88 per cent to be contaminated with harmful bacteria, yeast and mould. Conducted between December 2009 and February 2010, the survey used food pathogen screening on food samples from places like Nariman Point, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Shivaji Park and Haji Ali. Of the 70 samples collected, 61 were contaminated, many with faecal matter. Dr Shamma Shetye, HOD for molecular biology and microbiology at Metropolis, says, "The absence of a proper mechanism to check hygiene practices at eateries is a reason for worry." Now if only street food didn't taste so good. **by Nishat Bari**